

A photographer, a party and Singapore

Never a dull month, this one's been rollercoaster ride, peppered with the search for the perfect RAM. It's been 10 months since the first batch of Media One students enrolled, and it's already graduation time. Sigh, they grow so fast! And since any reason is a reason to party, we had a fully-fledged graduation ceremony with guest speakers, and all, i.e. free food!

Armed with the T of technology and the M of media, Media One students foray into their new lives, while some stay with us as employees in our various departments.

License to shoot

Speaking of professionals, we had an interesting guest this month—Sherwin Crasto, the senior news photographer from Reuters, who came to tell us a thing or two about digicams for our cover story. So he did, and how!

But like all good stories, let's start at the beginning. With a field as interesting as photography, and a technology as advanced as the one used for digital cameras, we needed the tests to be exhaustive and authoritative. And who could be more of an authority on digicams than the guys who tested 31 of them—someone who shoots using them exclusively, of course! So we dialled a few numbers and Jiten Gandhi, our in-house photographer-cum handy man, cum 'knower-of-all-important-people-who-hangout-in-Mumbai's-press-club' came to our rescue. Within a few calls he assured us that Sherwin would come down to the Nerul office, to share his wisdom with us. And we waited. And we called. And we waited, but Sherwin the Merlin, was always on some assignment or another. Aliasgar, the test-centre co-ordinator who was supposed to oversee the digicam test began to sprout ulcers. He would look at Jiten *bhai* for reassurance. So Jiten *bhai* pinned down a time, and fixed an appointment.

Sherwin is a soft-spoken man (except while driving),



who drives faster than he can click, and enchanted us with tales of danger, and the adventures he has on the job. So much so that Aliasgar was all but out the door to get a camera, and change his career.

In search of the perfect RAM

Singapore, the multi-cultural island is a haven for geeks with its cheap computer components, the latest gadgets and Simlin Square. It was also the place where Microsoft held its workshop for Office 2003. Mitul, from the Test Centre was put on the job of going to Singapore to evaluate the gadget scene there, note all the latest goodies, buy the most RAM he could fit into his luggage, and if he still had the time, to attend the workshop.

Even the best laid (travel) plans go awry. As excited as Mitul was to be one of the four people invited from India, and ECNR stood between him and Singapore. So Mitul ran around for three days to make it to the airport on the evening of the 6th (his plane was to leave at 12 am), only to find that the flight had been delayed. Finally in Singapore, Mitul faced another crisis, that of vegetarian food. While the other journalists feasted to exotic oriental cuisine that more often than not included pieces of indistinguishable meat, Mitul and fellow veggies tried hard to push boiled vegetables devoid of any salt of pepper, down their gullet. Finally the chef whipped up some plain pasta with veggies, much to their relief.

This conquered, Mitul extended his stay by a few days to shop for all the peripherals and components that he dare not come home without!



The Media One team with their mentors